

QSN: Does the tonaly app allow you to set a rhythm

If you're referring to **Tonaly: Songs, Scales & Theory** (the songwriting/music theory app), it does have playback of chord progressions and practice features, but it is **not primarily a rhythm or metronome app**. Based on the current feature descriptions, you can set tempo for playback, but there is limited support for custom rhythmic patterns. Users have specifically requested more rhythm options and time signatures beyond basic playback. ([App Store](#))

So:

Feature	Tonaly
Set tempo (BPM)	Yes
Play chord progressions	Yes
Metronome click	Limited/basic
Create custom rhythm patterns	Not really
Drum grooves/backing rhythms	No
Practice with specific rhythmic subdivisions	No

If your goal is to:

- **Practice piano scales with a beat** → Tonaly's tempo controls may be enough.
- **Practice jazz rhythms, syncopation, swing, polyrhythms, etc.** → you'll probably want a dedicated metronome app alongside Tonaly.

Can you tell me what instrument you're using and what you mean by "set a rhythm"? For example:

- 4/4 with a click?
- Bossa nova groove?
- Swing feel?

- Custom drum pattern?
- Rhythm for chord playback?

The answer depends on which of those you're trying to do.

What you're describing is actually a level beyond what Tonalys was designed for.

Tonalys is excellent for:

- Finding chord progressions.
- Exploring harmony and key relationships.
- Hearing basic playback of progressions.
- Exporting MIDI to another tool. ([Tonalys App](#))

But it doesn't really let you experiment with:

- Left-hand accompaniment patterns (Alberti bass, stride, walking bass, etc.).
- Different right-hand comping rhythms.
- Groove templates (bossa, swing, funk, gospel, pop ballad).
- Multiple rhythmic interpretations of the same progression.
- Piano-arrangement generation. Users have specifically asked for richer rhythm control and rhythmic variation. ([App Store](#))

For what you're trying to do as a pianist, I'd look at a different workflow.

Option 1: iReal Pro (my first recommendation)

Enter:

None
| Cmaj7 | Am7 | Dm7 | G7 |

Then:

- Select Jazz Swing, Bossa Nova, Pop, Ballad, Funk, Latin, etc.
- Hear hundreds of accompaniment styles.
- Change tempo instantly.
- Practice RH improvisation while the app provides LH-style accompaniment.
- Experiment with harmonic rhythm and feel.

Many jazz musicians use it exactly for this purpose.

Option 2: Band-in-a-Box

This is probably the closest thing to what you're imagining.

You enter a chord progression and it can generate:

- Different piano comping styles.
- Bass lines.
- Drums.
- Guitar.
- Jazz trio, pop band, Latin ensemble, etc.

You can hear the exact same progression transformed into:

- Bill Evans-style jazz
- Pop ballad
- Bossa nova
- Blues shuffle
- Contemporary worship
- Funk groove

It's incredibly useful for discovering rhythmic possibilities.

Option 3: Logic Pro / GarageBand + MIDI

A workflow I use when exploring ideas:

1. Create a simple chord progression.
2. Loop it.
3. Try:
 - Whole notes
 - Half notes
 - Anticipations
 - Syncopation
 - Different LH ostinatos
4. Swap drummer tracks and grooves.

You quickly discover that rhythm often changes the character of a progression more than the chords themselves.

Option 4: AI-assisted accompaniment

There are newer tools such as:

- Hookpad (Hooktheory)
- Piano Companion
- Scaler 3
- Captain Chords

Scaler in particular is interesting because it can generate:

- Voicings
- Rhythmic patterns

- Arpeggios
- Bass movements

from the same chord progression.

What I think you're really after

Suppose you enter:

None

| Fmaj7 | G | Em7 | Am |

Then press:

- "Jazz Waltz"
- "Neo Soul"
- "Bossa Nova"
- "Pop Ballad"
- "Gospel"
- "Latin Groove"

and instantly hear:

- Different LH bass patterns.
- Different RH comping rhythms.
- Different voicings.

Among current tools, **Band-in-a-Box** and **Scaler 3** get closest to that experience.

For a pianist who enjoys sitting at the keyboard and exploring harmony, I'd probably choose:

1. **Scaler 3** (most inspirational)
2. **iReal Pro** (best value and easiest)
3. **Band-in-a-Box** (most powerful but more complex)

Which piano styles are you most interested in exploring—jazz, pop songwriting, neo-soul, gospel, film music, or something else? That changes which tool I'd recommend.

QSN: Well, I'm learning to play pop accompaniment, and there's lots of things, lots of ways that you can play a song. You can just have a single note in the left hand. You can have octaves, you can have fifths, you could have walking basses. The right hand could play chord sus2, sus4. You can do one full chord per beat, or think of patient rhythms. There's almost an infinite combination of what you can do with your left hand and right hand. An app that would allow you to explore some of these by setting left-hand and right-hand mixes, the way that Taylor Swift might play piano or Ben Folds might, or something like that. That's the thing I'm after.

What you're describing is actually a level beyond what Tonalify was designed for.

Tonalify is excellent for:

- Finding chord progressions.
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- Hearing basic playback of progressions.
- Exporting MIDI to another tool. ([Tonalify App](#))

But it doesn't really let you experiment with:

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I think you've identified a gap in the market rather than a missing feature in Tonal.

What you're describing isn't really a **chord progression tool**. It's more of a **piano arrangement exploration tool**.

The challenge for pop piano is that the harmony is often trivial:

None

| C | G | Am | F |

The magic is in the arrangement:

Left hand options

- Root notes
- Octaves
- Octave + fifth
- Broken octaves
- 1-5-8 patterns
- Walking bass
- Pedal tones
- Rhythmic ostinatos
- Alternating bass

Right hand options

- Block chords
- Sus2 voicings
- Sus4 voicings
- Add9 voicings
- Shell voicings
- Arpeggios
- Broken chords
- Melody + chord fills

Rhythmic options

- Whole notes
- Half notes
- 8th-note pumping
- Anticipations
- Syncopation
- Pushes before the beat
- Ballad feel
- Pop-rock feel
- Singer-songwriter feel

The same progression can sound like:

- Taylor Swift
- Ben Folds
- Coldplay
- Elton John
- Sara Bareilles
- Adele

simply by changing these dimensions.

The closest thing I've found is actually **Scaler 3**.

Scaler has:

- Chord progression entry
- Performance patterns
- Arpeggios
- Bass patterns
- Voicing libraries

But it still thinks like a producer rather than a pianist.

If I were designing the app you're describing, I'd have something like:

Progression

None

| C | G | Am | F |

Left Hand Style

Dropdown:

- Root
- Octave
- Octave + Fifth
- Pop Ballad
- Singer-Songwriter
- Walking Bass
- Ben Folds
- Elton John
- Coldplay

Right Hand Style

Dropdown:

- Block Chords
- Broken Chords
- Add9 Pop
- Suspended Pop
- Gospel
- Arpeggiated
- Melody Driven

Groove

Dropdown:

- Straight 8ths
- Ballad
- Pop Rock
- Folk
- Shuffle
- 16th Pop

And the app would generate MIDI so you could immediately hear:

"What if this progression were played like Ben Folds?"

versus

"What if this progression were played like Taylor Swift?"

As a piano teacher, I'd go even further.

Most accompaniment patterns can be described as reusable templates.

For example:

Taylor Swift-style ballad

LH:

None

Root --- Fifth ---

RH:

None

Chord Chord

Lots of sustain pedal.

Coldplay

LH:

None

Octaves

RH:

None

Broken add9 chords

Continuous 8ths.

Ben Folds

LH:

None

Driving octaves

RH:

None

Rhythmic block chords

Heavy syncopation.

An app could contain 100–200 such templates and let you swap them instantly over the same progression.

What's interesting is that this is exactly the sort of thing modern AI is becoming good at. Instead of selecting from fixed patterns, you could type:

"Play this progression like a Taylor Swift piano ballad."

or

"Give me five Ben Folds-inspired accompaniment patterns."

and get MIDI examples.

For your specific goal of learning pop accompaniment, I'd actually be tempted to build a small prototype rather than buy an app. A web app with:

1. Chord progression input.
2. Library of LH patterns.
3. Library of RH patterns.
4. MIDI playback.

would teach accompaniment concepts far better than most current theory apps.

I'll take this one level down as a product concept: what the user does, what the musical model needs to represent, and what the first useful prototype should include.

Thought for a couple of seconds

Yes. The core idea is:

A chord progression is the skeleton; accompaniment is the body language.

The app should let you keep the same chords but rapidly audition different **left-hand**, **right-hand**, **rhythmic**, and **stylistic treatments**.

1. The central object: an “arrangement recipe”

Example:

None

Progression: | C | G | Am | F |

Time: 4/4

Tempo: 82 bpm

Feel: straight 8ths

Style: modern pop ballad

Then the app separates the piano part into layers:

None

Left hand: root + fifth broken pattern

Right hand: add9/sus2 voicings

Rhythm: anticipated chord changes

Density: medium

Register: mid-low LH, mid-high RH

Pedal: sustained

That combination becomes a **recipe**.

2. The key insight: mix-and-match piano dimensions

Left hand engine

The user chooses patterns like:

None

Root only

Octaves

Root-fifth-octave

Broken octave

Pulsing 8ths

Walking bass

Pedal bass

Arpeggiated bass

Power-pop octaves

Ballad 1-5-8

Right hand engine

Choices like:

None

Block triads

Inversions

Add9 voicings

Sus2/sus4 colour

Broken chords

High arpeggios

Off-beat stabs

Melody-top voicings

Ben Folds-style rhythmic punches

Coldplay-style repeated figures

Rhythm engine

Choices like:

None

Whole-note pads

One chord per beat
8th-note pulse
Anticipated pushes
Syncopated pop comping
Ballad broken pattern
Driving rock quavers
Sparse singer-songwriter

Style presets

This is where it becomes fun:

None
Taylor-style piano ballad
Ben Folds driving pop-rock
Coldplay arpeggiated anthem
Adele-style power ballad
Elton-style gospel pop
Sara Bareilles singer-songwriter
Musical-theatre pop

Not to copy artists exactly, but to describe **arrangement archetypes**.

3. The killer workflow

The user enters:

None
| C | G | Am | F |

Then presses:

None
Generate 10 treatments

The app returns:

1. Soft Taylor-style ballad
2. Driving Ben Folds-style 8ths

3. Coldplay add9 arpeggios
4. Adele-style octave bass + big RH chords
5. Sparse verse accompaniment
6. Chorus lift version
7. Walking bass version
8. Syncopated pop version
9. Gospel-pop suspended version
10. Minimal left hand + rhythmic right hand

Each one should be playable, loopable, slowed down, and exported as MIDI.

4. The learning layer

This should not just generate music. It should teach.

For each pattern, show:

None

LH: play root on beat 1, fifth on beat 3

RH: play add9 voicing on beats 2 and 4

Effect: creates a gentle singer-songwriter feel

Use for: verses, reflective sections, lower-energy choruses

Then:

None

Make it bigger

Make it simpler

Make it more syncopated

Make it more Taylor Swift

Make it more Ben Folds

Move it into chorus mode

5. MVP version

A first version could be quite simple:

None

Chord input

↓

Choose key/time/tempo

↓
Select LH pattern
↓
Select RH pattern
↓
Select rhythm feel
↓
Playback as MIDI piano
↓
Export MIDI / notation / practice view

Start with maybe:

10 left-hand patterns × 10 right-hand patterns × 8 rhythm feels = 800 useful combinations.

That is already enough to be musically valuable.

6. Best product positioning

I would not position it as a DAW or composition tool.

I'd position it as:

An accompaniment idea machine for piano players.

Or:

“Turn any chord progression into 50 playable pop piano arrangements.”

That is much clearer than “music theory app”.

The real value is helping a learner answer:

“I know the chords. Now what can I actually play?”

Yes good closest I found is <https://chordbot.com/>

Yes—and I think Chordbot is the closest existing product to the vision we're discussing. In fact, what caught my attention is that Chordbot isn't really a chord progression app at all. It's more like a lightweight accompaniment arranger. It lets you enter chords, choose instrument and comping patterns, mix tracks, and experiment with arrangements in real time. It includes dozens of comping presets, hundreds of instrument patterns, and MIDI export.  chordbot.com +2

But I think it stops one layer short of what a pianist wants.

Chordbot thinks like a producer

The workflow is:

Chord progression
→ Comping pattern
→ Backing track



It's essentially creating a band arrangement.  chordbot.com +1

What you want is more like a piano coach

The workflow would be:

Chord progression
→ Piano texture
→ Playing technique
→ Practiceable arrangement



For example:

| C | G | Am | F |



Instead of selecting:

Piano Pattern 27



You select:

LH:
Octave + fifth



RH:
Add9 voicings

Rhythm:
Anticipated ballad

Complexity:
Beginner

and the app literally shows you what to play.

What I think is missing from every tool I've seen is the concept of **accompaniment vocabulary**.

A pop pianist doesn't think:

"I need pattern 27."

They think:

"This verse needs to feel intimate."

or

"I need to build energy into the chorus."

or

"This sounds too busy."

So the controls should be musical:

Energy

1 2 3 4 5



Density

Sparse ↔ Busy



Movement

Static ↔ Flowing



Style

Singer-songwriter
Pop Ballad
Rock Piano
Gospel Pop
Indie Folk
Piano Anthem



Then the accompaniment engine chooses appropriate LH/RH patterns.

What's interesting is that I found a newer product called **Chord Rhythms** which is much closer to the educational side. It lets you enter lead sheets, apply rhythm patterns, see staff notation for both hands, hear playback, and experiment with hundreds of accompaniment patterns. The emphasis is explicitly on learning accompaniment rather than generating backing tracks.  Chord Rhythms

In some ways Chord Rhythms is closer to your goal than Chordbot.

I think there are actually **three products hidden inside your idea**:

Product 1: Accompaniment Explorer

Input:
Chords



Output:
50 different ways to play them

This is where Chordbot lives.

Product 2: Accompaniment Teacher

Why does this pattern work?
When should I use it?
What artists use it?



This is where piano students learn.

Product 3: Accompaniment AI

You type:

"Make this sound like a Coldplay verse."

or

"Give me a Ben Folds chorus."

or

"Simplify this for a beginner."

and it generates notation, MIDI, and playback.

This is where I think the market is going. There is already academic work on systems that generate pop piano accompaniments with controls over texture, voicing density, rhythmic complexity, and style.  [arXiv +1](#)

The part that interests me most is not the playback engine. That's largely solved.

The interesting problem is building a taxonomy of pop piano accompaniment:



- Verse patterns
- Pre-chorus patterns
- Chorus patterns
- Bridge patterns

- Taylor-style
- Coldplay-style
- Ben Folds-style
- Adele-style

- Beginner
- Intermediate
- Advanced

If that taxonomy existed, an AI could generate almost endless variations. Without it, you're just choosing from a long list of anonymous MIDI patterns.

A question I'd explore next is: **When you sit down with a new pop song and a lead sheet, what are the first 5–10 accompaniment patterns you naturally reach for?** That set of patterns is probably the seed of the entire product.

If i were to create that taxonomy for a range of different players, then what would be the ideal format and structure to keep it in - I;m thinking for programmatic use

If you're thinking about this as a product and not just a personal knowledge base, I'd strongly recommend **not** storing it as a collection of MIDI patterns or notation examples.

Instead, think of it as a **musical knowledge graph with parameterized templates**.

The mistake most music software makes is:

```
{  
  "name": "Pattern 27",
```

JSON



That's not reusable, searchable, or generative.

Instead I'd model it at several layers.

Layer 1: Accompaniment Archetype

This is the highest level concept.

```
{  
  "id": "pop_ballad_taylor_01",  
  "name": "Modern Pop Ballad",  
  "influences": ["Taylor Swift", "Gracie Abrams"],  
  "energy": 2,  
  "density": 2,  
  "movement": 2,  
  "difficulty": 1,  
  "contexts": [  
    "verse",
```



This allows AI and search to reason about it.

Layer 2: Left-Hand Pattern

Separate the pattern from the style.

```
</> JSON   
  
{  
  "id": "lh_001",  
  "name": "Root Fifth Pulse",  
  
  "meter": "4/4",  
  
  "pattern": [  
    {"beat": 1.0, "note": "root"},  
    {"beat": 3.0, "note": "fifth"}  
  ],  
  
  "register": "low",  
  "movement": "low",  
  "difficulty": 1  
}
```

The same LH pattern may appear in hundreds of styles.

Layer 3: Right-Hand Pattern

```
</> JSON   
  
{  
  "id": "rh_014",  
  
  "voicing_type": [  
    "sus2",  
    "add9"  
  ],  
  
  "rhythm": [  
    1.0,  
    2.5,  
    4.0  
  ],  
  
  "density": 2,  
  
  "voice_leading": "minimal"  
}
```

Again, independent from any song.

Layer 4: Style Composition

The interesting part.

A style references components.

```
</> JSON   
  
{  
  "style_id": "taylor_ballad",  
  
  "left_hand": [  
    "lh_001",  
    "lh_004"  
  ],  
  
  "right_hand": [  
    "rh_014",  
    "rh_022"  
  ],  
  
  "weights": {  
    "lh_001": 0.7,  
    "lh_004": 0.3  
  }  
}
```

Now the engine can generate variations.

Layer 5: Musical Intent

This is where it becomes powerful.

```
</> JSON   
  
{  
  "intent": "build_energy",  
  
  "changes": {  
    "density": "+1",  
    "register": "higher",  
    "rhythmic_activity": "+2"  
  }  
}
```

Then the system can transform arrangements.

Verse

↓

Build Energy

↓

Pre-Chorus

↓

Big Chorus



without needing explicit examples for everything.

Layer 6: Artist Vocabulary

I'd separate artist references from patterns.

For example:

</> JSON



```
{
  "artist": "Ben Folds",

  "traits": [
    "driving_octaves",
    "syncopated_block_chords",
    "aggressive_dynamics",
    "high_rhythmic_density"
  ]
}
```

Then:

</> JSON



```
{
  "artist": "Coldplay",

  "traits": [
    "repeating_figures",
    "add9_voicings",
    "wide_register",
    "steady_8ths"
  ]
}
```

This avoids legal and stylistic problems later.

Layer 7: The Most Important Thing

Store **descriptors**, not just patterns.

For every accompaniment pattern I'd include:

```
</> JSON
{
  "energy": 3,
  "density": 2,
  "movement": 4,

  "emotion": [
    "hopeful",
    "reflective"
  ],

  "contexts": [
    "verse",
    "bridge"
  ],

  "artists": [
    "Coldplay",
    "The Fray"
  ]
}
```

Because later you'll want to ask:

Show me low-density piano accompaniments suitable for a reflective verse.

or

Generate a chorus pattern with more movement than the current one.

That only works if the data is richly tagged.

If I were building this today with AI in mind, I would actually store it as three linked collections:

```
Patterns
  LH patterns
  RH patterns
  Rhythm patterns
  Voicing patterns
```

Styles

- Artist archetypes
- Genre archetypes

Transforms

- Build energy
- Simplify
- Add syncopation
- Move to chorus

That structure scales from 50 patterns to 50,000 patterns and gives an LLM enough semantic information to reason about arrangements rather than merely retrieve them. That's the architecture I'd choose if the end goal is an AI-powered "accompaniment explorer" rather than a static pattern library.



Thought for a couple of seconds >

Yes — this is exactly the right direction. I'd tighten the schema in three important ways.

1. Separate "musical event" from "semantic label"

Your LH pattern should not mix `note` and `interval` ambiguously. Better:

`</>` JSON



```
{
  "id": "lh_descending_open_fifths_001",
  "name": "Stepwise Descending Open Fifths",
  "meter": "4/4",
```

```

"events": [
  {
    "position": "1.0",
    "duration": "2.0",
    "pitches": [
      {"role": "bass_root"},
      {"role": "bass_root", "interval": "+P5"}
    ]
  },
  {
    "position": "3.0",
    "duration": "2.0",
    "pitches": [
      {"role": "bass_step_down"},
      {"role": "bass_step_down", "interval": "+P5"}
    ]
  }
],
"tags": ["descending_bass", "open_fifths", "low_register"],
"difficulty": 2
}

```

That makes it renderable into MIDI.

2. Use a normalized rhythmic grid

Instead of saying “1, 4, 7” informally, store rhythm as subdivisions.

For 4/4 eighth notes:

```

<> JSON
{
  "grid": "8th",
  "steps_per_bar": 8,
  "hits": [0, 3, 6],
  "accent": [1.0, 0.7, 0.9]
}

```

Then the engine can translate:

```

0, 3, 6
= beat 1, the “and” of 2, beat 4

```

This is far more programmatic than floating-point beats.

3. Add a “rendering constraints” layer

This is the missing piece. For piano, not every pattern is physically or stylistically valid.

</> JSON



```
{
  "rendering_constraints": {
    "max_hand_span": "octave",
    "left_hand_register": ["C2", "C4"],
    "right_hand_register": ["C3", "C6"],
    "avoid_muddy_intervals_below": "C3",
    "voice_leading": "minimal",
    "pedal": "sustain_per_chord"
  }
}
```

Without this, generated arrangements will sound plausible in theory but bad on piano.

Stronger canonical structure

I'd store each artist/archetype as:

</> JSON



```
{
  "id": "artist_vocab_taylor_live_piano",
  "type": "artist_vocabulary",
  "influence": "Taylor Swift live piano/acoustic performances",

  "traits": [
    {
      "id": "static_right_hand_anchor",
      "description": "Right hand repeats a stable interval while harmony changes under",
      "musical_function": "creates continuity and emotional tension",
      "compatible_patterns": ["rh_static_anchor_036"]
    },
    {
      "id": "descending_left_hand_bass",
      "description": "Left hand drives emotional motion through stepwise bass movement",
      "musical_function": "creates narrative descent and harmonic pull",
      "compatible_patterns": ["lh_descending_open_fifths_001"]
    }
  ],

  "typical_intents": [
    "intimate_verse",
    "build_to_bridge",
    "mashup_transition",
    "final_chorus_lift"
  ]
}
```

The key architectural move

I would split the taxonomy into five concrete file types:

```
patterns/  
  lh/  
  rh/  
  rhythm/  
  voicing/  
  
styles/  
  artist_vocabularies/  
  genre_archetypes/  
  
recipes/  
  complete_accompaniment_recipes/  
  
transforms/  
  build_energy.json  
  simplify.json  
  make_more_syncopated.json  
  
renderers/  
  piano_constraints.json
```



So a Taylor-like accompaniment is not one blob. It is:

```
LH pattern + RH motif + rhythm grid + voicing rule + intent transform + piano i
```



That gives you reuse, variation, AI search, MIDI generation, and teaching explanations.

The taxonomy should therefore be **JSON/YAML source of truth**, probably validated with **JSON Schema or Pydantic**, with generated outputs into MIDI, MusicXML, and app-native formats.



okay could we write a concise spec to give to an expert
who could create this exactly for Taylor's style

Thought for a second >

Yes — here's a concise spec you could hand to a music-domain expert.

Specification: Taylor Swift Live Piano Accompaniment Taxonomy

Objective

Create a structured, programmatically usable taxonomy of Taylor Swift's live piano/acoustic accompaniment style. The output should enable a software system to generate playable pop-piano accompaniments from arbitrary chord progressions, especially in the style of Taylor Swift's solo piano performances, acoustic sets, and mashup transitions.

The goal is not to transcribe songs exactly, but to identify reusable accompaniment patterns, rhythmic motifs, voicing strategies, bass movement types, dynamic shapes, and performance intents.

Scope

Analyse Taylor Swift live piano/acoustic performances and produce a taxonomy covering:

1. Left-hand accompaniment patterns.
2. Right-hand rhythmic and voicing motifs.
3. Bass movement strategies.
4. Harmonic simplification techniques.
5. Dynamic build patterns.
6. Verse, chorus, bridge, outro, and mashup-transition use cases.
7. Difficulty levels suitable for beginner to intermediate pianists.

Required Deliverables

1. Artist Vocabulary

Define Taylor Swift's recurring live-piano traits as reusable descriptors.

Example traits:

- Static right-hand anchor.
- Heartbeat rhythmic motif.
- Descending bassline.
- Open fifths.
- Octave bass reinforcement.

- Tonic simplification.
- Add2/sus2 colour tones.
- Dynamic bridge build.
- Sparse verse-to-big-chorus expansion.
- Mashup-compatible accompaniment continuity.

Each trait should include:

```
{
  "id": "static_right_hand_anchor",
  "name": "Static Right-Hand Anchor",
  "description": "Right hand repeats a stable interval or chord fragment",
  "musical_function": "Creates continuity, emotional tension, and vocal support",
  "typical_contexts": ["verse", "bridge build", "mashup transition"]
}
```

2. Left-Hand Pattern Library

Create a library of left-hand patterns using symbolic musical roles rather than fixed notes.

Each pattern should include:

```
{
  "id": "lh_descending_open_fifths_001",
  "name": "Stepwise Descending Open Fifths",
  "meter": "4/4",
  "events": [
    {
      "grid_position": 0,
      "duration_steps": 4,
      "pitches": [
        {"role": "bass_root"},
        {"role": "bass_root", "interval": "+P5"}
      ]
    },
    {
      "grid_position": 4,
      "duration_steps": 4,
      "pitches": [
        {"role": "bass_step_down"},
        {"role": "bass_step_down", "interval": "+P5"}
      ]
    }
  ]
}
```

```

],
"tags": ["descending_bass", "open_fifths", "low_register"],
"difficulty": 2
}

```

Include patterns such as:

- Root-only bass.
- Octave roots.
- Open fifths.
- Root-fifth-octave.
- Stepwise descending bass.
- Pedal bass.
- Sustained bass + rhythmic right hand.
- Chorus octave reinforcement.

3. Right-Hand Pattern Library

Create a right-hand motif library focused on repeated, modular rhythmic figures.

Each pattern should include:

```

{
  "id": "rh_static_heartbeat_036",
  "name": "Static Heartbeat Motif",
  "voicing_type": ["power_chord", "sus2", "add2"],
  "rhythm_grid": {
    "subdivision": "8th",
    "steps_per_bar": 8,
    "hits": [0, 3, 6],
    "accents": [1.0, 0.7, 0.9]
  },
  "voice_leading": "static",
  "density": 3,
  "difficulty": 2,
  "tags": ["heartbeat", "syncopated", "static_anchor"]
}

```

Include motifs such as:

- Whole-note pads.
- Beat 1 and 3 support.
- Quarter-note pulses.
- 8th-note heartbeat patterns.

- Syncopated 1-and-4-and style motifs.
- Repeated suspended chord fragments.
- Build patterns with increasing rhythmic density.

4. Style Recipes

Define complete accompaniment recipes that combine left hand, right hand, rhythm, dynamics, and intended song section.

Example:

```
{
  "id": "recipe_taylor_bridge_build_001",
  "name": "Taylor-Style Bridge Build",
  "influence": "Taylor Swift live piano/acoustic performance",
  "contexts": ["bridge", "final chorus build", "mashup transition"],
  "left_hand_patterns": [
    {"id": "lh_descending_open_fifths_001", "weight": 0.7},
    {"id": "lh_octave_roots_001", "weight": 0.3}
  ],
  "right_hand_patterns": [
    {"id": "rh_static_heartbeat_036", "weight": 1.0}
  ],
  "energy": 4,
  "density": 3,
  "movement": 2,
  "difficulty": 2,
  "pedal": "sustain_per_chord"
}
```

5. Transformation Rules

Define how an accompaniment changes across song sections.

Required transforms:

```
{
  "id": "transform_build_to_bridge_climax",
  "name": "Build to Bridge Climax",
  "changes": {
    "dynamics": "+2",
    "density": "+1",
    "left_hand_register": "widen_to_octaves",
    "right_hand_activity": "increase_syncopation",
    "pedal": "more_sustained"
  }
}
```

```
}  
}
```

Include transforms for:

- Simplify for verse.
- Build into chorus.
- Build into bridge.
- Reduce for outro.
- Make more intimate.
- Make more anthem-like.
- Make mashup-compatible.

6. Rendering Constraints

Provide piano-specific constraints so generated material remains playable and idiomatic.

```
{  
  "max_hand_span": "octave",  
  "left_hand_register": ["C2", "C4"],  
  "right_hand_register": ["C3", "C6"],  
  "avoid_muddy_intervals_below": "C3",  
  "voice_leading": "minimal",  
  "pedal_strategy": "sustain_per_chord",  
  "target_player_level": "beginner_to_intermediate"  
}
```

Output Format

Deliver taxonomy as structured JSON or YAML files, preferably organised as:

```
artist_vocabularies/  
  taylor_swift_live_piano.json
```

```
patterns/  
  left_hand/  
  right_hand/  
  rhythm/  
  voicing/
```

```
recipes/  
  taylor_live_piano/
```

```
transforms/
```

```
build_energy.json  
simplify.json  
bridge_climax.json
```

```
rendering_constraints/  
pop_piano_beginner_intermediate.json
```

Important Modelling Rules

- Do not create exact song transcriptions.
- Do not hardcode MIDI files as the primary source of truth.
- Use symbolic roles such as `bass_root` , `chord_fifth` , `add2` , `sus4` , and `bass_step_down` .
- Patterns must be transposable to any key.
- Patterns must work over arbitrary chord progressions.
- Every pattern should include musical function, suitable context, difficulty, density, and emotional descriptors.
- The taxonomy should support both MIDI generation and educational explanation.

Success Criteria

The taxonomy is successful if a software system can take a progression such as:

```
| C | G/B | Am | F |
```

and generate multiple Taylor-style accompaniment treatments, including:

1. Sparse verse version.
2. Static right-hand heartbeat version.
3. Descending-bass bridge build.
4. Wider octave chorus version.
5. Softer outro version.

Each generated arrangement should be playable by an intermediate pianist, recognisably aligned with Taylor Swift's live piano vocabulary, and explainable in musical terms.



this is good but i need a shorter version as well please

A good expert usually wants a **one-page brief** first, then the detailed spec as an appendix.

Brief: Taylor Swift Piano Accompaniment Taxonomy



Brief: Taylor Swift Piano Accompaniment Taxonomy

Objective

Create a structured taxonomy of Taylor Swift's live piano accompaniment style that can be used by software to generate new piano arrangements from arbitrary chord progressions.

The goal is not song transcription. The goal is to identify and model the reusable musical building blocks that define her accompaniment vocabulary.

Scope

Analyse live performances, acoustic sessions, surprise songs, mashups, and solo piano arrangements to identify:

- Left-hand bass patterns
- Right-hand rhythmic motifs
- Voicing strategies
- Dynamic build techniques
- Verse, chorus, bridge, and outro behaviours
- Characteristic stylistic traits

Deliverables

1. Artist Vocabulary

Identify and describe recurring Taylor Swift accompaniment traits such as:

- Static right-hand anchor
- Heartbeat rhythm
- Descending bass movement
- Open fifths
- Add2/sus2 voicings
- Dynamic bridge builds
- Sparse-to-big arrangement arcs

2. Pattern Library

Create reusable, transposable patterns for:

- Left hand
- Right hand
- Rhythm
- Voicing

Patterns should be symbolic and key-independent rather than fixed-note transcriptions.

3. Style Recipes

Define combinations of patterns that create recognisable Taylor-style accompaniment behaviours for:

- Verse
- Chorus
- Bridge
- Outro
- Mashup transition

4. Transformations

Define rules that convert one arrangement state into another, including:

- Build energy
- Simplify
- Intensify chorus
- Create bridge climax
- Reduce for outro

5. Playability Rules

Define piano-specific constraints including:

- Hand span
- Register ranges
- Voice-leading preferences
- Pedalling behaviour
- Beginner/intermediate difficulty levels

Success Criteria

Given a progression such as:

| C | G/B | Am | F |

the taxonomy should allow software to generate multiple Taylor-style accompaniments, including:

- Sparse verse
- Heartbeat accompaniment
- Descending-bass build
- Anthemic chorus
- Soft outro

Each result should be playable, transposable, explainable, and recognisably aligned with Taylor Swift's live piano vocabulary.

This is probably the version I'd send to a pianist, arranger, musicologist, or AI music researcher before giving them the detailed schema. It tells them *what to discover* rather than *how to encode it*.



